

Mini Blame

Installation & User Guide

1. Introduction

Mini Blame is a lightweight, blazing-fast Git blame extension for Visual Studio Code. Designed to provide instant inline Git history, detailed hover popups, and quick actions, it skips the heavy indexing of massive extensions to keep your editor running fast and smooth.

2. Prerequisites

- **Visual Studio Code:** Version 1.80.0 or higher.
- **Git:** Must be installed on your system and accessible via the system PATH.
- **A Local Git Repository:** The extension only activates when the opened workspace is an initialized Git repository.

3. Local Installation (VSIX)

Since this extension is packaged as a standalone local installer file (`.vsix`), you can install it completely offline in just a few clicks:

1. Open **Visual Studio Code**.
2. Navigate to the **Extensions** view by clicking the square icon on the left Activity Bar, or by pressing `Ctrl + Shift + X` (Windows/Linux) or `Cmd + Shift + X` (Mac).
3. In the top-right corner of the Extensions panel, click the **Views and More Actions** icon (the three horizontal dots `...`).
4. From the dropdown menu, select **Install from VSIX...**
5. A file explorer window will open. Locate your generated `mini-blame-0.0.1.vsix` file and double-click it.
6. Look for a small notification in the bottom right corner of VS Code confirming that the installation was successful. No restart is required!

4. How to Use Mini Blame

Once installed, Mini Blame runs seamlessly in the background. Simply open any tracked file inside a Git repository to start using it.

Feature	How to Access
Inline Ghost Text	Click on any line of code. The author, relative date, and commit message will gently fade in at the end of the line.
Status Bar Indicator	Look at the bottom right of the VS Code window. The active line's commit info is permanently visible here. Hover over it to see the full commit subject.
Rich Hover Details	Hover your mouse over the "Ghost Text" at the end of your current line. A detailed popup will appear showing the commit body, branch name, and exactly what code was changed.
Quick Actions Bar	Inside the hover popup, click the interactive icons to instantly copy the Commit SHA, Branch Name, or Pull Request number to your clipboard.
Side-by-Side Diff	In the hover popup, click the Open changes with previous revision icon to instantly view the historical code diff in a new VS Code tab.
Time Travel (Browse Old File)	In the hover popup, click the ... menu and select Browse File at Revision to open the entire file exactly as it looked in the past.

5. Troubleshooting

Extension not showing up? Ensure the folder you have opened in VS Code is the actual root of a Git repository. Mini Blame requires an active workspace folder to execute its shell commands.

Text too hard to read? Mini Blame uses VS Code's native "Ghost Text" theming. If it is too light or dark, changing your active VS Code Color Theme will automatically adjust the extension's text color.